ULTIMATE CYBERSECURITY MASTER BLUEPRINT 2026-2027

Start Here: Easy Resource Guide

Exact websites, exact playlist order, lecture SOP and zero-confusion daily workflow

Edition: Start Here
Resource verification date: 2026-10-27
Plan window: 2026-10-27 to 2027-10-26 (shift dates if you start later)
System: 365 days, 12 academic months, 52 weeks + 1 graduation day
Profile: BS CS student in Pakistan; free/high-value resources; safe authorized labs

Academic-style self-study manual. No employment, salary, visa, certification or top-1% guarantee.

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Start Here: exact websites, exact order, zero confusion

Purpose. Ye short guide bats ata hai ke roz kis website par jana hai, kis button/learning path ko follow karna hai, lecture kaise dekhna hai, aur time waste kaise rokna hai. Poori detailed 365-day plan Volume 2-4 mein hai; yahan sirf operating system hai.

> **Roman Urdu rule:** "Video dekh li" is not study. Har lecture ke baad ek command, ek lab result, ek retrieval answer, aur ek commit hona chahiye. Agar 1 hour hai to bhi "Core track" complete karo; baaki optional extension Day 7 ya weekend par.

1. One-minute decision tree

Aaj ki situation	Exact action
Bilkul new din aur naya topic hai	Volume 2-4 mein aaj ka `MxxWxDy` card kholo → Primary resource link par jao → exact section parho/dekho → Core practical task karo → evidence file save karo → retrieval question ka answer likho.
Website samajh nahi aa rahi	Section 3 "Website use karne ka exact tarika" mein uss website ka row parho.
Video dekhne ka mann hai but lab nahi karna	Video ko 20-25 minute ke chunk mein dekho; har chunk ke baad pause karke command/code reproduce karo. Lab skip allowed nahi.
Lab error aa gaya	Error ka exact text copy karo → error log mein likho → primary docs/man page search karo → ek variable change karke retest karo → fix aur root cause dono likho.
Time kam hai	Core track (~1h): 20 min resource, 30 min minimum lab, 10 min retrieval + log. Standard (~2h) adds one variation. Intensive (3-4h) adds independent extension.
Assessment fail hua (<70/100)	Scorecard mein lowest category mark karo → primary resource ka exact section dobara parho → supplementary alternate explanation use karo → same exercise nayi input par dobara karo → naya mini-test do → agle din retest. Advanced topic par tab tak na jao jab tak critical prerequisite weak hai.
Motivation kam hai	Day 7 ka light revision/catch-up karo; streak todne se behtar hai 30-minute honest retrieval. Burnout ko data ki tarah treat karo, guilt ki tarah nahi.

2. Daily study SOP (the 5/25/45/15/10 method)

1. **Preview — 5 min.** Aaj ke card se topic, subtopics, objective aur completion criteria parho. Notebook mein likho: "Mujhe kya prove karna hai?"
2. **Input — 25 min.** Primary lecture ya docs ka assigned section. Video ho to exact playlist/lesson title match karo; timestamps tabhi use karo jo video page par actually dikhte hon. Kisi PDF mein likhe hue invented timestamp par trust na karo.
3. **Hands-on — 45 min (Core: 25-30).** Exact practical task karo. Har command/code apne VM/container/browser lab mein type karo; copy-paste ke baad bhi ek variation khud likho.
4. **Retrieval — 15 min.** Book/notes band karke aaj ka revision question answer karo. Apne words mein 5-8 lines. Phir answer compare karo.
5. **Evidence — 10 min.** Expected output file/screenshot/command log banao, hash ya timestamp add karo, Git commit ya journal entry karo.

Standard track (~2h) adds: one modified exercise, one documented error, and one extra retrieval question. **Intensive track (~3-4h)** adds: an independent extension from a blank file/VM, a mini teach-back paragraph, and one primary-documentation lookup. Har din 4 hours zaroori nahi.

3. Website use karne ka exact tarika

Website / platform	Account? / cost	Kahan jana hai	Exact workflow	Common mistake
Harvard CS50x / CS50 Cyber	Free OCW; edX certificate optional paid	https://cs50.harvard.edu/x/ or https://cs50.harvard.edu/cybersecurity/	Weeks → choose current week → Lecture/Notes/Problem Set → submit where free gradebook available. YouTube playlist sirf lecture dekhne ke liye.	Sirf YouTube dekhna aur problem sets skip karna.
YouTube playlists	Free	Exact playlist links in Volume 5 and the "Playlist control panel"	Playlist open karo → video title aur course objective match karo → 20-25 min chunk → pause → reproduce → notes → lab.	Channel homepage se random video hopping.
Jeremy's IT Lab CCNA	Free YouTube; optional paid course	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLxbwE86jKRgMpuZuLBivzlM8s2Dk5lXBQ and course index https://courses.jeremysitlab.com/p/ccna	Course index se exact "Day N" title lo → playlist mein woh lecture dhundo → Packet Tracer lab file download karo → lab complete karo → Anki cards review.	Subnetting sirf dekhna; daily 20 questions na karna.
Professor Messer	Free videos; paid notes optional	Course index https://www.professormesser.com/security-plus/sy0-701/sy0-701-video/sy0-701-comptia-security-plus-course/	Objective code (e.g., 1.2) se exact video title dhoondo → video dekho → usi objective ka hands-on lab karo. certification version check karo: SY0-701 V7 vs upcoming SY0-801 V8.	Purane SY0-601 playlist ko current samajhna.
Linux Journey	Free	https://linuxjourney.com/	Lesson parho → apne Ubuntu VM mein har command dobara type karo → result aur error command notebook mein likho.	Browser lesson complete karna but VM practice na karna.
OverTheWire Bandit	Free	https://overthewire.org/wargames/bandit/	Official level page parho → SSH se connect karo → level solve karo → **concept** note likho; passwords/flags publicly publish na karo.	Walkthrough copy karna; ye independent problem-solving ko destroy karta hai.
PortSwigger Web Security Academy	Free account	Learning Paths https://portswigger.net/web-security/learning-paths → current path → topic → Apprentice lab	Read topic → launch lab → Burp scope set karo → solve without walkthrough → root cause + remediation note likho.	Lab solve karna but defensive fix na likhna.
OWASP projects	Free	Top 10 https://owasp.org/www-project-top-ten/, ASVS https://owasp.org/www-project-application-security-verification-standard/, Cheat Sheets https://cheatsheetseries.owasp.org/	Standards ko checklist ki tarah use karo; har requirement ko apne local project ke test se map karo.	OWASP page ko step-by-step course samajhna; ye reference hai.
TryHackMe	Freemium	https://tryhackme.com/path/outline/presecurity then Cyber Security 101	Free account → free rooms filter → browser AttackBox ya local VM → notes. Paid subscription tabhi jab aapne free equivalent labs complete kiye ho.	Subscription lena aur phir bhi sirf videos dekhna.
Hack The Box Academy	Freemium	https://academy.hackthebox.com/	Free modules filter → module resources download → isolated VM/HTB environment → notes.	Cubes/subscription ko skill samajhna.
pwn.college /	Free	Dojo index https://pwn.college/dojos or https://www.cylabacademy.org/	Core Material order follow karo → module lecture → browser workspace → challenge → concept journal.	Software Exploitation dojo directly try karna

Website / platform	Account? / cost	Kahan jana hai	Exact workflow	Common mistake
CyLab Academy				before Linux/C/ assembly.
CyberDefenders / BTLO / Malware Traffic Analysis	Freemium/ Free datasets	https://cyberdefenders.org/, https://blueteamlabs.online/, https://malware-traffic-analysis.net/	Dataset download karo → hash karo → disposable VM mein analyze karo → questions ka answer evidence ke saath likho.	Malware samples ko host machine par run karna. Files data hain; execute mat karo.
MITRE ATT&CK / NIST / CISA	Free	https://attack.mitre.org/, https://www.nist.gov/cyberframework, https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog	Exact technique/control/CVE search karo → apne lab evidence se map karo → limitations likho.	Framework ko law ya certification samajhna.
Microsoft Learn / AWS Skill Builder	Free content; exams paid	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/, https://skillbuilder.aws/	Learning path → module → knowledge check → optional sandbox → free practice assessment. AWS hands-on se pehle Free Tier terms aur billing alarms set karo.	Credit card add karke paid resources enable karna bina budget alert ke.
Docker / Kubernetes docs	Free	https://docs.docker.com/, https://kubernetes.io/docs/home/	Get Started → exact concept/task → local Docker/kind/minikube → cleanup.	Vulnerable container ko public port par expose karna.
GitHub / Git	Free	https://git-scm.com/book/en/v2, https://docs.github.com/en/code-security	Repo → README → branch → commit → PR → CI → secret scan.	`.env`, private log, API key ya real IP/ public identifier commit karna.

4. Playlist control panel: channel + exact link + kab use karein

> Exact dates: YouTube par individual video ka upload date dekho. Neeche "course year" ya first-publication year diya gaya hai jahan official page/search result se verify hua. Kisi bhi video timestamp ko PDF mein invent nahi kiya gaya; video ke apne chapters use karo.

Order	Channel / provider	Exact playlist or full-course link	Kab aur kaise	Cost	Age / status warning
1	CS50 (Harvard)	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLhQjrBD2T380hlTqAU8HfvVepCcjCqTg6	Month 1, Week 0-9 ke concepts; official course page ke saath	Free	2026 edition; current
2	CS50 (Harvard)	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLhQjrBD2T3839iqxqUdw7NWOCboh00vsV	CS50 Sections; jab lecture ka example samajh na aaye	Free	2026; optional
3	CS50 (Harvard)	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLhQjrBD2T383Cqo5I1oRrbC1EKRAKGKUE	Month 5 core security ke saath	Free	2023 lectures; old but gold
4	freeCodeCamp.org	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eWRfhZUzrAc	Month 4 Python fundamentals; 25-min chunks	Free	2022; concepts still valid
5	Jeremy's IT Lab	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?	Month 2 networking; Day 1 se sequential	Free	

Order	Channel / provider	Exact playlist or full-course link	Kab aur kaise	Cost	Age / status warning
		list=PLxbwE86jKRgMpuZuLBivzIM8s2Dk5lXBQ			Started 2020; v1.1 additions; **old but gold**, current exam blueprint verify karo
6	Professor Messer	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnl_tQe3kvnmeMid0mjF8Le8	Month 2 targeted Network+ objective review	Free	N10-009; 2024 onward
7	Professor Messer	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnl4QDVqK-hOnoqcSKEIDDuv	Month 5 core security objective review	Free	SY0-701 2023-24; V8 launch Nov 2026
8	MIT OpenCourseWare	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLUl4u3cNGP62K2DjQLRxDNRi0z2IRWnNh	Year 2+ systems security research; selected lectures	Free	Fall 2014; old but gold, update tools
9	Stanford Online / Dan Boneh	https://www.coursera.org/learn/crypto	Month 5 optional rigorous crypto; free audit/lectures where available	Free mium	Classic; primitives durable, current protocols verify karo
10	pwn.college	https://www.youtube.com/c/pwncollege	Year 2+ dojo lecture support; use dojo index first	Free	Channel dates vary; current dojo first
11	OpenSecurityTraining2	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=11KJYHCwcrE	Year 2+ Arch1001 intro; full course on OST2 site	Free	2022 intro; old but gold
12	Microsoft Azure Data Explorer	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLKHIhZJiQ5AkOMEC54mQQcAkfg4UXT8uK	Month 8 KQL essentials	Free	Dates vary; docs first
13	Microsoft exam prep	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLahhVEj9XNTcHNtYH-inn7xFJactEM7zz	Month 8/10 SC-200 exam-prep supplement	Free	Objectives refreshed 2026; official study guide first
14	AWS	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLRFRM3JNuCkvtHYbxjeEA4vx3G4NrqTn3	Year 2+ AWS Security Specialty concept supplement; verify current SCS-C03 guide	Free	Exam content changes; official guide first
15	SANS Digital Forensics	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLrY_AbzZGqt9MJiLjyH-zTrypGLs154e4	Month 8/Year 2 DFIR artifact webcasts	Free	Mixed dates; webcast ≠ SANS course
16	SANS DFIR	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL4mjNXFbBRJmippWE8BYMVx0ERb9fdBcP	Network forensics practice with sample captures	Free	Older webcasts; technically useful
17	SANS	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLfouvuAjspTp23StynIAowjTK2n-5i1QG	Threat-analysis/CTI supplement after Month 8	Free	Dates vary; primary advisories first
18	picoCTF / CyLab	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLJ_vkrXdcgH9HTNVNIXco0urgrLt349VN	picoCTF 2026 competition/ lecture archive	Free	2026 competition; practice site changed to CyLab Academy
19	KQL community playlist	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?	Extra KQL examples after official docs	Free	Publication dates vary; verify syntax with Microsoft docs

Order	Channel / provider	Exact playlist or full-course link	Kab aur kaise	Cost	Age / status warning
		list=PLWf6TEjiiuIDDXxYJQryn0KxZ5OjdG83n			
20	PortSwigger community demos	https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLDVnRJQ0p1WUP6zgjrlrDq5wixceuE5Do	Optional visual demo only; Academy labs are primary	Free	Unofficial playlist; never replace official labs

5. Time-waste control rules

1. **One primary resource per day.** Supplementary sirf alternate explanation ya gap ke liye.
2. **Do not collect playlists.** Har week ke liye sirf assigned lessons; baaki "backlog" folder mein, not in your study queue.
3. **No walkthrough on first attempt.** 20-30 min struggle karo, phir hint, phir documentation, aakhir mein solution. Solution ke baad problem ko naye input se dobara solve karo.
4. **No tool tourism.** Nmap, Burp, Wireshark, Docker, Sigma aur KQL ko gehra seekho; har naya tool tabhi add karo jab project mein zarurat ho.
5. **Certificate is not curriculum.** Exam voucher tabhi kharido jab official objectives + free practice + portfolio evidence ready ho.
6. **No unauthorized testing.** PortSwigger labs, TryHackMe/HTB, pwn.college, local VMs aur explicitly authorized ranges ke alawa kisi public system ko scan/exploit mat karo.
7. **Weekly stop rule.** Agar 2 hafte se zyada backlog hai to naya module shuru mat karo; pehle Day 7 catch-up protocol use karo.

6. Your first two hours (today)

1. Folder banao: `cybersecurity-blueprint/`, `journal/`, `evidence/`, `projects/`, `scripts/`.
2. VM install karo: VirtualBox + Ubuntu LTS (official links: https://www.virtualbox.org/manual/, https://help.ubuntu.com/).
3. Git repo banao: `git init`, README, `.gitignore`, first commit.
4. Open Volume 2, Day `M01W1D1`, primary resource F01, and complete the Core track.
5. Stop after evidence file + retrieval answer. **Don't watch five extra videos.** Kal ka card kal.